

USER MANUAL

From brief to reviewed moving-image draft

WINDOWS 11 + NVIDIA CUDA

Plan. Direct. Review.

A practical, visual guide to the five-stage studio workflow, with worked examples from the fictional Northstar Flow campaign.



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What this system is for

Turn a marketing objective, brand rules and optional source images into an approved concept, timed storyboard and reviewable video draft.

Local-first creative workstation

The studio keeps project state, references and local draft generation on this Windows PC. OpenAI planning and Higgsfield evaluation are optional provider paths.

Review before generation

Brief, concept and storyboard gates make decisions visible. Paid cloud generation requires a separate estimate and approval.

Inside this guide

01	Brief & brand	Define the assignment and the rules.
02	Existing images	Upload and describe references.
03	Concept & script	Shape the idea and one continuous narration.
04	Storyboard	Time scenes, prompts and reference assignments.
05	Review paths	Create a local rough cut or quote a cloud evaluation.

One project, five controlled stages

Work from the top of the studio downward. Approve only when the current stage is ready to drive the next one.

1

Brief & brand

Goal, audience, claims, look, CTA and length



2

Existing images

Product, character, style and location references



3

Concept & script

Creative direction and continuous voiceover



4

Storyboard

Variable scene timing, prompts and references



5

Review paths

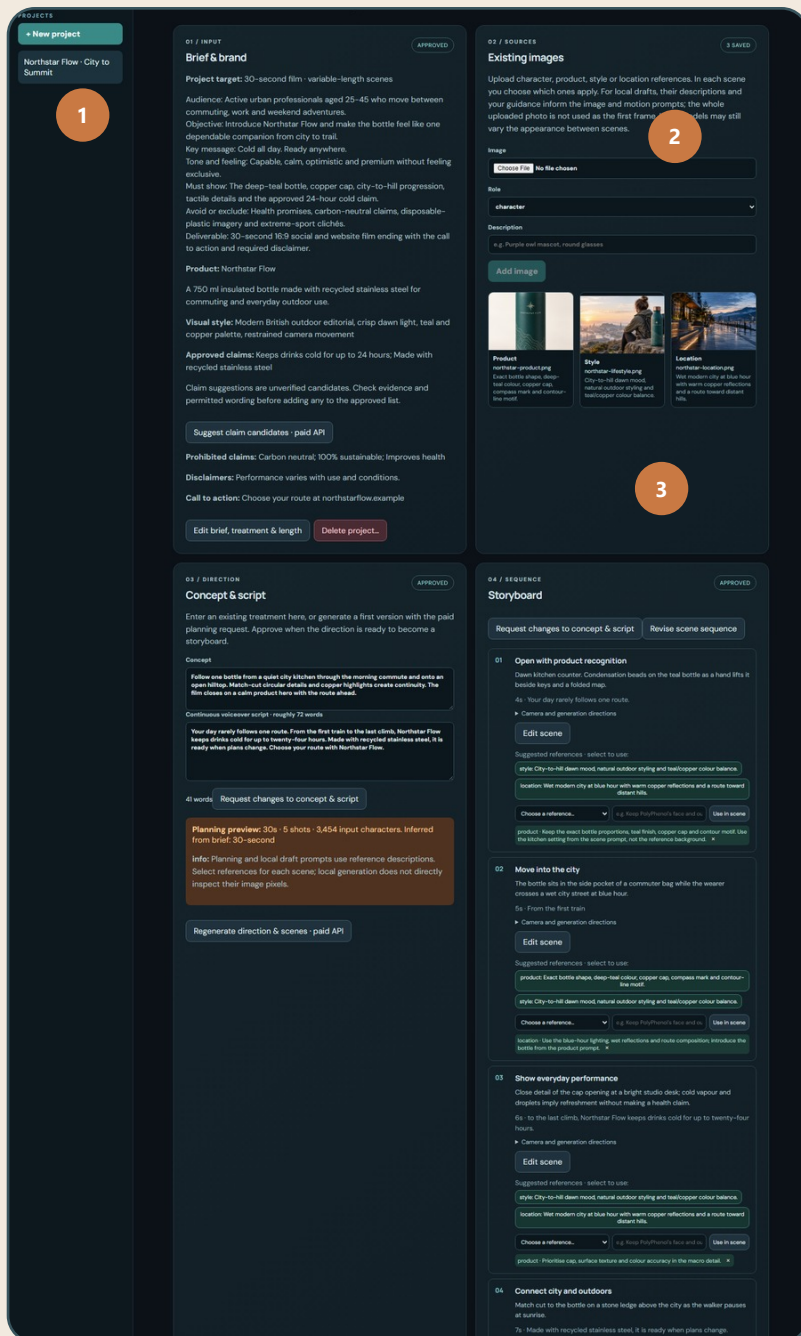
Local rough cut or approved cloud evaluation

APPROVAL RULE

An approval is a checkpoint, not a lock forever. Request changes when needed; the studio resets dependent work so old outputs are not mistaken for current ones.

How to move around the studio

Projects stay in the left sidebar. The working area follows the numbered stages from top to bottom.



1. Project list

Open an existing project or start a new one. Project data is stored locally.

2. Draft status

The header reminds you that generated outputs are AI drafts for non-commercial review.

3. Numbered stages

Complete, revise and approve each stage before moving to downstream generation.

GOOD HABIT

Name projects by campaign and version, for example: Northstar Flow - Launch 01.

SETUP ACCESS

Use Setup & Diagnostics to add API keys or repair the local foundation later.

Brief & brand

This stage defines what the film must achieve and the boundaries the plan must respect.

01 / INPUT

APPROVE 1

Brief & brand

Project target: 30-second film · variable-length scenes

Audience: Active urban professionals aged 25–45 who move between commuting, work and weekend adventures.

Objective: Introduce Northstar Flow and make the bottle feel like one dependable companion from city to trail.

Key message: Cold all day. Ready anywhere.

Tone and feeling: Capable, calm, optimistic and premium without feeling exclusive.

Must show: The deep-teal bottle, copper cap, city-to-hill progression, tactile details and the approved 24-hour cold claim.

Avoid or exclude: Health promises, carbon-neutral claims, disposable-plastic imagery and extreme-sport clichés.

Deliverable: 30-second 16:9 social and website film ending with the call to action and required disclaimer.

Product: Northstar Flow

A 750 ml insulated bottle made with recycled stainless steel for commuting and everyday outdoor use.

Visual style: Modern British outdoor editorial, crisp dawn light, teal and copper palette, restrained camera movement

Approved claims: Keeps drinks cold for up to 24 hours; Made with recycled stainless steel

Claim suggestions are unverified candidates. Check evidence and permitted wording before adding any to the approved list.

Suggest claim candidates · paid API

Prohibited claims: Carbon neutral; 100% sustainable; Improves health

Disclaimers: Performance varies with use and conditions.

Call to action: Choose your route at northstarflow.example

Edit brief, treatment & length Delete project...

2

3

4

1. Target length

Choose 15, 30, 45 or 60 seconds. All scene timings must later add up to this target.

2. The assignment

State the audience, objective, message, tone, must-show content, exclusions and deliverable. Put a supplied treatment in its own field.

3. Brand controls

Describe the product and visual style. Add only claims and wording that a responsible reviewer has checked.

4. CTA and approval

Tell viewers what to do next, then approve the brief when every required rule is represented.

IMPACT

Saving changes to the brief, brand or target length resets the current plan and approvals. Uploaded reference images remain available.

What a strong brief can include

The brief may be concise or detailed. Useful specificity improves the plan; repeated slogans and contradictory instructions create noise.

Audience

Who should care, what they already know, and where they will watch.

Objective

The one change in understanding or action the film should create.

Key message

The single thought viewers should remember.

Product and proof

Features, approved evidence and exact permitted claim wording.

Tone

Emotional register, pace, voice and qualities to avoid.

Visual direction

Lighting, palette, environments, product treatment and camera feel.

Must show

Product moments, people, locations, end card, CTA and disclaimers.

Restrictions

Prohibited claims, imagery, competitors, unsafe actions or visual cliches.

Format

Target length, 16:9 output, platform context and review purpose.

BRIEF VERSUS TREATMENT

Use the brief for the assignment and rules. Use Existing treatment for supplied concepts, scripts, shot lists or timed storyboards. The two remain separately editable.

HOW LONG CAN IT BE?

The brief accepts substantial detail, but every sentence should change a decision. Prefer clear headings and exact approved wording. Move scene-by-scene direction into the treatment or storyboard.

Sample briefs: 15 and 30 seconds

These examples show the level of specificity that helps without prescribing every frame.

15-second product teaser - Ember Oat Latte

Audience: Busy commuters aged 20-35.

Objective: Make the new canned oat latte feel like a convenient morning treat.

Key message: Barista-style flavour, ready from the fridge.

Tone: Bright, tactile and energetic.

Must show: Can opening, creamy pour, pack front and end-card CTA.

Avoid: Health claims, exaggerated steam and coffee-shop logos.

Approved claim: Made with British oats.

CTA: Find your nearest stockist at [ember.example](#).

Deliverable: 15-second 16:9 launch teaser with three fast scenes.

30-second worked example - Northstar Flow

Audience: Active urban professionals aged 25-45 who move between commuting, work and weekend adventures.

Objective: Introduce Northstar Flow as one dependable companion from city to trail.

Key message: Cold all day. Ready anywhere.

Tone: Capable, calm, optimistic and premium without feeling exclusive.

Must show: Deep-teal bottle, copper cap, city-to-hill progression, tactile details and the approved 24-hour cold claim.

Avoid: Health promises, carbon-neutral claims, disposable-plastic imagery and extreme-sport clichés.

Approved claims: Keeps drinks cold for up to 24 hours; made with recycled stainless steel.

Disclaimer: Performance varies with use and conditions.

CTA: Choose your route at [northstarflow.example](#).

Deliverable: 30-second 16:9 website and social film.

NOTICE

The 15-second version is narrower and faster. The 30-second version has room for a visual journey, two approved claims and a calmer close.

Sample briefs: 45 and 60 seconds

Longer films need a reason to be longer: demonstration, explanation, testimony or a more developed emotional turn.

45-second software explainer - LedgerLoop

Audience: Owners of small creative agencies who lose time reconciling project costs.

Objective: Demonstrate a simple weekly workflow and encourage a free trial.

Key message: Know where every project stands before Friday.

Tone: Clear, calm and practical; no futuristic AI cliches.

Must show: Import, project health view, one alert and final summary. Use supplied UI screenshots as references only in the scenes that show the product.

Avoid: Guaranteed savings, fake customer names and unreadable interface text.

CTA: Start a 14-day trial at ledgerloop.example.

Deliverable: 45-second 16:9 explainer with continuous narration and six scenes.

60-second local service story - BrightNest Heating

Audience: Homeowners considering a heat-pump survey.

Objective: Reduce uncertainty about the survey process and invite qualified enquiries.

Key message: A clear plan begins with a careful home assessment.

Tone: Reassuring, knowledgeable and neighbourly.

Must show: Engineer arrival, room measurements, existing system inspection, homeowner discussion, written recommendation and booking CTA.

Avoid: Guaranteed savings, exact grant promises, unsafe equipment access and identifiable real addresses.

Required disclaimer: Eligibility, costs and performance depend on the property and assessment.

CTA: Book an assessment at brightnest.example.

Deliverable: 60-second 16:9 information film with eight scenes and a measured pace.

ADAPT SAFELY

Replace every fictional claim, URL and disclaimer with wording that has been checked for the real campaign. AI suggestions are candidates, not evidence.

Length changes the creative job

The application offers 15, 30, 45 and 60 seconds. It shows a rough script allowance of about 2.4 words per second; treat that as a ceiling, not a target.

Length	Useful starting shape	Script ceiling	Typical pressure
15s	3-4 scenes; one message	about 36 words	Fast recognition and one action
30s	4-6 scenes; simple arc	about 72 words	Balance story, claim and CTA
45s	6-8 scenes; demonstration	about 108 words	Keep every step visually distinct
60s	7-10 scenes; explanation	about 144 words	Protect pace and viewer attention

What length affects

- Narration: more time permits context, but pauses and emphasis still need space.
- Scene count: more scenes create more prompts, reference choices and review decisions.
- Scene duration: every scene must be 2-30 seconds and the total must exactly match the film target.
- Local preview: scenes longer than about five seconds use time-stretched preview motion; timing and continuous narration remain correct.
- Cloud cost: longer billable duration and higher resolution generally increase the estimate.
- Consistency risk: more generated scenes create more opportunities for product, person and location drift.

PRACTICAL RULE

Start with the shortest length that can carry the objective, proof and CTA clearly. Add time only when it improves understanding or feeling.

Existing images

Upload reusable visual references, describe what matters, then choose them scene by scene.

02 / SOURCES

3 S 1

Existing images

Upload character, product, style or location references. In each scene you choose which ones apply. For local drafts, their descriptions and your guidance inform the image and motion prompts; the whole uploaded photo is not used as the first frame. Local models may still vary the appearance between scenes.

Image

Choose File No file chosen

Role

2

character

Description

e.g. Purple owl mascot, round glasses

Add image



Product
northstar-product.png
Exact bottle shape, deep-teal colour, copper cap, compass mark and contour-line motif.



Style
northstar-lifestyle.png
City-to-hill dawn mood, natural outdoor styling and teal/copper colour balance.



Location
northstar-location.png 3
Wet modern city at blue with warm copper reflections and a route toward distant hills.

1. Upload

Accepted reference types are PNG, JPEG and WebP. Use a clear, relevant image rather than a crowded contact sheet.

2. Role + description

Choose character, product, style, location or other. Describe the identity, attributes and visual qualities worth preserving.

3. Reusable library

Saved images remain available across the project. Select a card to revise its role or description.

IMPORTANT

Uploading does not apply an image to every scene. Assign it only where its influence is useful.

DELETION

Removing a linked image also removes it from those scenes and forces their downstream approvals back to review.

Choose the right role and file

The role tells reviewers why the image exists. The description tells planning and local generation what should carry forward.

Product

Shape, materials, colour, packaging details and distinctive marks.

Tip: Use a clean packshot with minimal background.

Character

Face, outfit, silhouette or mascot identity.

Tip: Use one clear subject; state which features matter.

Style

Lighting, palette, texture, composition or photographic treatment.

Tip: Avoid recognisable products you do not want copied.

Location

Architecture, geography, layout and atmosphere.

Tip: Use a view that shows spatial relationships.

Other

A prop, graphic motif or reference that does not fit the standard roles.

Tip: Explain its exact purpose in the description.

DESCRIPTION PATTERN

Identity + specific traits + what may change. Example: 'Exact bottle shape, teal finish and copper cap. Background and surface may change to match the scene.'

Local prompts and cloud pixels behave differently

The same scene assignment has a different technical effect in the two review paths.

Local rough cut

The local planner uses the reference role, description and scene guidance to inform image and motion prompts. The uploaded pixels are not used as the first frame. Appearance may vary between scenes.

Use descriptions that name the features to preserve and write the scene environment separately.

Higgsfield evaluation

Selected images are uploaded and used as actual visual references for that scene. Scenes with no selected image use text-to-video.

The source background, lighting, clothing or other photographed details may influence the result even when your prompt asks for something else.



SCENE GUIDANCE EXAMPLE

'Keep the exact bottle proportions, teal finish, copper cap and contour motif. Use the scene's kitchen setting, not the product-photo background.'

- Use the fewest references that solve the scene.
- Do not attach a lifestyle photo when only product identity is needed.
- Review people, locations and backgrounds for rights and suitability before cloud upload.
- Character and product consistency are goals, not guarantees.

Concept & script

Turn the approved brief into one creative idea and one continuous narration track.

03 / DIRECTION

APPROVED

Concept & script

Enter an existing treatment here, or generate a first version with the paid planning request. Approve when the direction is ready to become a storyboard.

Concept

Follow one bottle from a quiet city kitchen through the morning commute and onto an open hilltop. Match-cut circular details and copper highlights create continuity. The film closes on a calm product hero with the route ahead.

Continuous voiceover script · roughly 72 words

Your day rarely follows one route. From the first train to the last climb, Northstar Flow keeps drinks cold for up to twenty-four hours. Made with recycled stainless steel, it is ready when plans change. Choose your route with Northstar Flow.

41 words Request changes to concept & script

Planning preview: 30s · 5 shots · 3,454 input characters. Inferred from brief: 30-second

info: Planning and local draft prompts use reference descriptions. Select references for each scene; local generation does not directly inspect their image pixels.

Regenerate direction & scenes · paid API

1. Concept

Explain what happens, the visual progression and why it supports the objective.

2. Continuous script

Write one narration across the whole film. The storyboard later divides timing cues by scene.

3. Planning preview

Check duration, expected shot count, input size and warnings before a paid planning request.

4. Generate or edit

Enter your own direction, extract a supplied treatment for free, or call the paid OpenAI planning path.

APPROVAL

Approve only when the concept and narration express the approved brief. Request changes to reopen editing.

Write narration that leaves room to breathe

The app's rough allowance is about 2.4 words per second. Natural delivery often needs fewer words, especially with claims, unfamiliar names or dramatic pauses.

Do	Avoid
Read the script aloud and time it.	Filling every second with speech.
Use one thought per sentence.	Repeating the visual description word for word.
Place exact approved claims carefully.	Turning a feature into a new unsupported promise.
Leave space for the CTA and disclaimer.	Rushing legal or qualifying language.
Keep one continuous narrative voice.	Writing each scene as a disconnected advert.

NORTHSTAR EXAMPLE - 41 WORDS

'Your day rarely follows one route. From the first train to the last climb, Northstar Flow keeps drinks cold for up to twenty-four hours. Made with recycled stainless steel, it is ready when plans change. Choose your route with Northstar Flow.'

Using an existing treatment

- Paste concepts, scripts, shot lists and timings into Existing treatment in Step 1.
- Use Extract concept & voiceover from treatment for a free structured starting point.
- Review the extraction warnings and edit the result; extraction does not approve creative decisions.
- If the treatment contains timed scenes, Step 4 can extract them after concept approval.

PAID PLANNING

Generating or regenerating direction and scenes uses the configured OpenAI API. Review the planning preview before submitting.

Storyboard

Break the approved direction into timed scenes. Each scene combines intent, visuals, camera direction, narration timing and generation prompts.

04 / SEQUENCE

APPROVED

Storyboard

Request changes to concept & script

Revise scene sequence

1

01 Open with product recognition

Dawn kitchen counter. Condensation beads on the teal bottle as a hand lifts it beside keys and a folded map.

4s - Your day rarely follows one route.

► Camera and generation directions

Edit scene

Suggested references - select to use:

style: City-to-hill dawn mood, natural outdoor styling and teal/copper colour balance.

location: Wet modern city at blue hour with warm copper reflections and a route toward distant hills.

Choose a reference...
e.g. Keep PolyPheno's face and ou

Use in scene

product - Keep the exact bottle proportions, teal finish, copper cap and contour motif. Use the kitchen setting from the scene prompt, not the reference background. ✕

2

02 Move into the city

The bottle sits in the side pocket of a commuter bag while the wearer crosses a wet city street at blue hour.

5s - From the first train

► Camera and generation directions

Edit scene

Suggested references - select to use:

product: Exact bottle shape, deep-teal colour, copper cap, compass mark and contour-line motif.

style: City-to-hill dawn mood, natural outdoor styling and teal/copper colour balance.

Choose a reference...
e.g. Keep PolyPheno's face and ou

Use in scene

location - Use the blue-hour lighting, wet reflections and route composition; introduce the bottle from the product prompt. ✕

3

03 Show everyday performance

Close detail of the cap opening at a bright studio desk; cold vapour and droplets imply refreshment without making a health claim.

6s - to the last climb, Northstar Flow keeps drinks cold for up to twenty-four hours.

► Camera and generation directions

Edit scene

Suggested references - select to use:

style: City-to-hill dawn mood, natural outdoor styling and teal/copper colour balance.

location: Wet modern city at blue hour with warm copper reflections and a route toward distant hills.

Choose a reference...
e.g. Keep PolyPheno's face and ou

Use in scene

product - Prioritise cap, surface texture and colour accuracy in the macro detail. ✕

4

04 Connect city and outdoors

Match cut to the bottle on a stone ledge above the city as the walker pauses at sunrise.

7s - Made with recycled stainless steel, it is ready when plans change.

► Camera and generation directions

Edit scene

Suggested references - select to use:

product: Exact bottle shape, deep-teal colour, copper cap, compass mark and contour-line motif.

1. Sequence tools

Revise all scenes together or edit one scene in place.

2. Scene intent

Purpose, visual and duration should make the scene's job clear before prompt detail.

3. Reference choices

Suggestions are optional. Assign a selected image and write guidance for this scene.

4. Linked reference

The green tag records the active assignment and guidance.

TIMING

The total must exactly equal the project target before storyboard approval.

What every scene field controls

Write each field for its own purpose. Repeating the same sentence everywhere gives models less useful direction.

Purpose

Why the scene exists in the story.

Example: Open with product recognition.

Duration

How long it occupies in the final timeline.

Example: 4 seconds.

Visual

What the viewer should see, including setting and action.

Example: Condensation on the bottle as a hand lifts it beside keys.

Camera

Framing, lens feel and movement.

Example: Slow 50 mm push-in; match cut on the copper cap.

Narration

The phrase or timing cue that lands during the scene.

Example: Your day rarely follows one route.

Image prompt

Composition, subject, light, material and still-image detail.

Example: Premium dawn product photograph; tactile condensation; calm kitchen.

Video prompt

Movement through time for subject, camera and environment.

Example: Hand enters naturally and lifts the bottle; keep proportions stable.

Negative prompt

Specific defects or content to suppress.

Example: Warped bottle, extra fingers, changed colour, illegible mark.

PROMPT PATTERN

Subject + action + setting + composition + light + materials + constraints. Put motion in the video prompt and stable appearance requirements in the reference guidance.

Assign references with intent

A reference becomes active only after you choose it, add optional guidance and select Use in scene.

► Camera and generation directions

Edit scene

Suggested references · select to use:

style: City-to-hill dawn mood, natural outdoor styling and teal/copper colour balance.

location: Wet modern city at blue hour with warm copper reflections and a route toward distant hills.

Choose a reference_ ▼ e.g. Keep PolyPhenol's face and ou Use in scene

1 Product · Keep the exact bottle proportions, teal finish, copper cap and contour motif. Use the kitchen setting from the scene prompt, not the 2 reference background. ✕

02 Move into the city

The bottle sits in the side pocket of a commuter bag while the wearer

3

1. Suggestions

The studio compares roles and descriptions with the scene. A suggestion is a shortcut, not an instruction.

2. Guidance

State what to preserve and what may change. Mention conflicts between source background and the intended scene.

3. Linked tag

Confirm the role and guidance. Remove the tag when that influence is no longer wanted.

GOOD ASSIGNMENT

Product packshot + 'Keep bottle proportions, teal finish and copper cap. Replace the studio background with the scene environment.'

RISKY ASSIGNMENT

Lifestyle photo + no guidance. A cloud model may carry over the photographed person, clothing, skyline and light when you only wanted the bottle.

Rough cut

Use local compute to check structure, timing, narration and visual direction before considering cloud spend.

05A / LOCAL REVIEW

PENDING

Rough cut

Local video model

LTX 2B · fast preview

Ready for local rendering. LTX 13B may exceed this GPU's memory; Wan and LTX 13B still need a live benchmark here.

Narration voice

Sarah · American female

Save voice

Changing voice keeps the video clips. Generate the local draft again to create new narration, captions and a rough cut.

Generate local draft

The local draft will appear here when generated.

1. Video model

Choose an installed local model. LTX 2B is the known fast-preview route; other models require their weights and machine validation.

2. Narration voice

Choose an installed English voice. Saving a new voice keeps video clips but requires a new rough-cut assembly.

3. Generate

The studio creates storyboard frames, motion clips, narration, captions and an assembled review video.

REVIEW FOR

Message order, scene timing, narration pace, caption sense, product drift and any reference influence that feels too strong.

LOCAL LIMITATION

Uploaded image pixels are not used as first frames in the current local path. Longer scenes use time-stretched preview motion. The rough cut is for creative review, not commercial use.

Higgsfield video test

This optional path prepares one Seedance 2.5 clip per storyboard scene, then assembles them with the local narration and captions.

05B / CLOUD EVALUATION
NOT START 1

Higgsfield video test

Model: Seedance 2.5 via Higgsfield API · 16:9. Each storyboard scene becomes one cloud video clip. Selected uploaded images are sent as visual references for that scene; scenes without images use Seedance text-to-video. The clips are assembled with one continuous local draft narration and captions.

Cloud video resolution

480p · lower cost 2

Getting an estimate uploads the selected reference images to Higgsfield, but does not submit a paid generation. Higgsfield currently provides an approximate per-second rate for the selected resolution; the studio totals that rate across the scenes before any account discount. Your approval is required before rendering.

Higgsfield API key is not configured. Open Setup & Diagnostics to save your complete key-id:key-secret credential. Website plan credits are separate from the API balance.

This is an AI-generated, non-commercial evaluation. A reference image includes its photographed background; the model may reproduce it despite scene direction, and character consistency is not guaranteed. 3

Prepared scenes: 5 · 30s

Scene 1 · 4s	1 image reference
Scene 2 · 5s	1 image reference
Scene 3 · 6s	1 image reference
Scene 4 · 7s	1 image reference
Scene 5 · 8s	1 image reference

Get 480p Higgsfield estimate · no generation 4

1. Model + format

The current route uses Seedance 2.5 at 16:9, with a 480p or 720p choice.

2. Estimate first

Requesting an estimate may upload selected references, but it does not submit paid video generation.

3. Prepared scenes

Review each duration and reference count. Prompt-only scenes use text-to-video.

4. Approve spend

The estimate is approximate and before discounts. Approve the specific quote before rendering.

CLOUD WARNING

A reference includes its photographed background. Character and product consistency are not guaranteed.

What changes reset downstream work

The studio invalidates dependent approvals and outputs so that the current state remains traceable.

Change	What remains	What needs review again
Brief, brand or target length	Uploaded references	Concept, storyboard, rough cut, cloud quote
Concept or narration	Brief approval and references	Storyboard, rough cut, cloud quote
Scene timing or prompt	Brief and concept	Storyboard approval and generated drafts
Reference metadata or assignment	Source image	Affected scene outputs and downstream approvals
Narration voice	Generated video clips	Narration, captions and rough-cut assembly
Cloud resolution	Storyboard	A fresh matching estimate

A reliable revision loop



AVOID

Do not regenerate the whole campaign to fix one weak scene. Edit that scene's visual, camera, prompts or reference assignment first.

Costs, approvals and practical limits

The studio separates planning, local compute and cloud rendering so each decision is visible.

OpenAI planning

Used for paid direction, scene generation and claim candidates when configured. The preview reports size and warnings before submission. Manually entered direction remains available without it.

Local generation

Uses your machine, Pinokio, ComfyUI, local models, Kokoro, Whisper and FFmpeg. There is no provider charge, but rendering consumes time, storage and GPU resources.

Higgsfield evaluation

The estimate is based on prepared scenes, billable duration and resolution. It is approximate, before discounts and not a spending cap. The app stops if the published estimate rises before submission.

Human responsibility

Confirm claims, rights, privacy, brand accuracy, disclaimers and suitability. Check the provider console if submission state is uncertain; never replay an ambiguous paid request blindly.

Current limits to remember

- All generated outputs are non-commercial drafts in this release.
- LTX content must retain an intelligible AI-generated disclaimer wherever displayed or shared.
- A reference can guide identity but cannot guarantee consistency.
- An API key proves configuration, not available credit or model access.
- Website subscription credits may differ from API billing.

DECISION POINT

Approve a cloud estimate only after the storyboard, selected references, resolution and account context are correct.

Fast troubleshooting

Start with the visible stage that failed. Avoid changing several upstream inputs at once.

Symptom	Check first	Action
Planning button disabled	Brief approval, API key, preview blockers	Approve or resolve the named warning.
Storyboard cannot approve	Scene total versus target	Adjust durations until the totals match exactly.
Wrong product appearance	Reference role, description and scene link	Use a clean product image and explicit guidance.
Reference background appears	Cloud reference contains that background	Use a cleaner source or state what to replace.
Narration feels rushed	Word count and pauses	Shorten the script; regenerate narration and assembly.
Local draft button disabled	Storyboard approval and model readiness	Approve the storyboard or install/select a ready model.
Cloud estimate disabled	Higgsfield key, errors, uncertain run	Open Setup, fix preflight, or reconcile the earlier request.
Interrupted paid submission	Higgsfield API console	Recover by request ID or confirm no request exists.

DIAGNOSTICS

Open Setup & Diagnostics to recheck the local foundation, API configuration and model readiness. Export diagnostics when you need a shareable technical record; review it before sending.

DO NOT GUESS

When a paid cloud request was interrupted, use the provider console and the recovery controls. Do not resubmit until you know whether the first request exists.

Pre-render checklist

Use this list before local generation and again before approving cloud spend.

☐ The objective, audience and key message agree.

☐ Claims and disclaimers use reviewed wording.

☐ The CTA is clear and appropriate for the deliverable.

☐ The concept supports the brief without adding unsupported promises.

☐ The narration reads naturally within the target time.

☐ Scene durations total exactly 15, 30, 45 or 60 seconds.

☐ Every scene has a distinct purpose and usable image/video prompts.

☐ Only useful references are assigned, with scene-specific guidance.

☐ Source-image rights, privacy and cloud-upload suitability are checked.

☐ The selected local model or cloud resolution matches the review goal.

☐ The latest estimate matches the current storyboard and references.

☐ A human reviewer understands that the output is a non-commercial AI draft.

Useful terms and locations

Term	Meaning
Reference	An uploaded source image that can be assigned to selected scenes.
Guidance	Scene-specific instruction describing how a reference should influence output.
Rough cut	Locally assembled draft video for structural and creative review.
Evaluation	Optional Higgsfield cloud draft, still non-commercial in this release.
Project files	Stored under the studio data/projects folder; use the studio to preserve lineage.

KEEP BESIDE THE STUDIO

Return to Step 1 when the assignment changes, Step 4 when a scene needs work, and Setup & Diagnostics when local tools or provider access change.

NORTHSTAR FLOW DEMO ASSETS ARE FICTIONAL